

VERBAL ABILITY – 9-9-26

Directions for question 1: The following question below has a sentence. From the choices provided, identify the one which best restates the given sentence and mark its corresponding letter as the answer.

Whether the criterion is human health or the health of the wider environment, the benefits, of organic farming are beyond question and hence positive action needs to be instituted so that its benefits can be maximized.

- ☐ a) Organic farming should be extensive as it benefits not only human beings but also the environment.
- ☐ b) Action needs to be initiated to maximize the benefits of organic farming as it has amazing results for the health of human beings as well as the soil.
- ☐ c) The important question raised today is about organic farming since it benefits not only human beings but also the environment in which we live.
- ☒ d) Positive measures should be initiated to maximize the benefits of organic farming, both for the sake of human beings and the environment. (Your answer - ✓)

Directions for questions 2 to 4: The following question has a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

A fascinating academic paper published this week found strong evidence that a gender gap in corruption-related attitudes and behaviours is indeed present in democracies, but the gap is weaker or non-existent in autocracies. It argues that women have stronger incentives to adapt to political norms because of the risks created by gender discrimination – under patriarchal systems, women are subject to greater social pressure to adhere to prevailing social expectations. Women, they say, will be resistant to corruption in places where it is already culturally and institutionally stigmatised, but behave identically to men where such practices are simply a normal part of doing business, or even expected. _____

- ☐ a) This suggests that bringing more women into politics remains an urgent and necessary goal for many other reasons.
- ☐ b) This suggests that women are more trustworthy and public-spirited than men, and the greater the representation of women in parliaments around the world, the lower the level of corruption.
- ☐ c) This suggests that the gender gap in corruption-related attitudes and behaviours is indeed present in all democracies.

- ☒ d) This suggests that merely bringing more women into politics will not reduce corruption; instead, the process of democratisation reduces corruption and simultaneously helps to bring women into politics. (Your answer - ✓)

Show Correct Answer

Hide Solution

PREVIOUS

NEXT

Solution:

The passage argues that there is strong evidence that a gender gap in corruption-related attitudes and behaviours is present in democracies. Women have stronger incentives to adapt to political norms because of the risks created by gender discrimination. They will be resistant to corruption in places where it is culturally and institutionally stigmatised, but behave identically to men where such practices are simply a normal part of doing business. The argument leads to the conclusion that merely bringing more women into politics will not reduce corruption, but the process of democratisation can reduce corruption as well as bring more women into politics. Option D is the right concluding sentence. A is irrelevant as there is no reference in the passage to the urgency of bringing women into politics. B can also be ruled out because 'being trustworthy and public spirited' is not the crux of the passage. Option C is irrelevant as it is just a repetition of a part of the first sentence of the passage.

Choice (D)

Dust pollution produced during the 9/11 terrorist attack on the World Trade Centre caused babies in the area to be born prematurely and with low birth weight, a new study has found. Experts say that this may have implications for cities such as New Delhi that grapple with polluted air. When the towers of the World Trade Centre in New York City fell on September 11 in 2001, a cloud of hazardous material enveloped the surrounding neighbourhood and coated everything and everyone exposed to it for several days. _____

- ☒ a) Out of the 2 million births, they isolated data of women who lived in Lower Manhattan neighbourhoods and were most exposed to the dust cloud. (Your answer - ✗)

- ☐ b) The study was conducted by researchers from the University of Zurich in Switzerland and Princeton University in the US by examining birth records of babies born in New York City between 2001 and 2004. (Correct Answer - ✓)

- ☐ c) There was also an increase in the number of babies with low birth weights, which can lead to later issues such as higher risk for diabetes, heart disease and elevated blood pressure.
- ☐ d) Exposure to air pollution in the womb can have adverse health effects on newborns, which can play out over the course of a lifetime, 'National Geographic' reported.

Directions for questions 2 to 4: The following question has a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

A detoxifying drink used in traditional Indian medicine, golden milk owes its name to the bright yellow colour of turmeric. Mixed with warming spices like cinnamon, pepper and ginger, this sugar-free and antioxidant drink is a pleasant alternative to coffee, or Christmas season staples mulled wine and hot chocolate. _____

- ☐ a) Easy to prepare, this hot, sweet, milky drink is not only tasty, but also healthy, especially in the winter months when its warming spices give it a Christmassy flavour.
- ☐ b) The ochre-coloured root of turmeric is also a standard ingredient in Indian and Thai cuisines.
- ☒ c) Known for their anti-inflammatory, antioxidant and anti-carcinogenic properties, these ingredients activate the happiness hormone, serotonin. (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ d) It is made by forming a paste of water, turmeric and pepper, which is then combined with coconut, soy or almond milk, along with a dash of coconut oil or cold-pressed extra-virgin olive oil, honey or cinnamon are added for extra flavour and sweetness.

Directions for questions 5 to 7: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is represented by a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question

- (1) Shaw believed that he had ability and plenty of experience.
- (2) But Shaw was particularly persistent and kept working, kept submitting, kept believing, and kept hoping.
- (3) Several factors are important in this story of this late Irish playwright.
- (4) For nine long years before George Bernard Shaw got anything published, editors turned down everything he sent in.
- (5) In the process of all that writing, he got better and better until, ultimately, nine years after he submitted his first manuscript, he got something published.

Your Answer: 31425 ✗

Correct Answer: 42531 ✓

Solution:

The short passage describes the indefatigable effort made by the late George Bernard Shaw before he eventually became a published and successful Irish English playwright. Finding the first sentence of the passage isn't that hard. Since the passage is about the playwright, it is appropriate that at least one sentence should devote itself wholly to introducing him before something else is said of him. So the sentence that is introductory of the playwright in the passage is (4) which tells us how much the playwright struggled before he could become a published writer. The use of the conjunction "But" at the head of the second sentence (2) contrasts with the first sentence. The first sentence (4) states the period that Shaw spent writing to editors; however, in the second sentence (2) the author says what Shaw did in order to win or earn the belated recognition/reward. The author is commending the untiring efforts made by Shaw; the dramatist kept working, kept submitting, kept believing and kept hoping until he was vindicated for his tireless efforts. In the first sentence the author has quoted the complete name but in the second he is addressed by his last name (Shaw). The use of the complete name and the surname suggest coherence between the two sentences. In the third sentence (5) the use of the pronouns "he" and "his" cements the connection between the previous two sentences and the third one. These pronouns are a cohesive device used to link sentences into a meaningful whole. So far in the three sentences the author has used coherent and cohesive devices to build a meaningful paragraph. The fourth sentence (3) sums up what is responsible for Shaw's belated success. The sentence says that there are several important factors that shaped the story. The fifth sentence (1) confirms another factor which determined his success: belief in his ability to write.

Ans : (42531)

Directions for questions 5 to 7: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is represented by a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question

- (1) As I walked into the reception area, where the staff members had assembled temporarily, one of them asked, "How are you doing?"
- (2) In the summer of 1996, I had health problems that resulted in two days of hospitalization.
- (3) I responded, "Actually, I'm not doing well at all.
- (4) A few days after my hospital stay, I had an early-morning dental appointment.
- (5) I've had a bad case of the shingles combined with diverticulitis, which resulted in the loss of over three pints of blood, and my energy level is low."

Your Answer: 24135 

Solution:

The current passage is about the author's health problems and the consequent hospitalization. The author dates his health problems to 1996 and they debuted in sentence (2). When we come to the second sentence (4), we are told that the author had already been discharged from hospital. The subject of the first two sentences is the author's health problems and thereby this common subject establishes coherence between the first two sentences. The third sentence (1) has it that the author went to hospital for dental treatment. It was in this hospital's reception area that one of the medical staff members asked the author about his health condition. The author's reply is given in the fourth sentence (3). His reply was in the negative and in direct speech. Evidently the fourth sentence (3) opens the quotes and they end in the fifth. So far all the four sentences are thematically united by one subject: the author's health condition. In the fifth sentence (5), however, the author elaborates on his health problem. This sentence too is in direct speech, as evidenced by the quotes at the end of the sentence. The quotes which were opened in the fourth sentence (3) were closed in the fifth sentence (5).

Ans : (24135)

Directions for questions 5 to 7: The sentences given in each of the following questions, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is represented by a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences that constructs a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question

- (1) However, my data showed that if I made a certain number of calls day in and day out, I'd get a certain percentage of appointments.
- (2) Having been in sales all my life, I have come to appreciate that success is determined more by effort than by luck.
- (3) Out of those presentations, I'd get a certain number of sales.
- (4) Occasionally, when I would hit the jackpot with a big sale or a large number of sales that came in a flurry, colleagues would accuse me of being lucky.
- (5) Out of those appointments, I'd get a certain number of presentations.

Your Answer: 42153 ✖

Correct Answer: 24153 ✔

Solution:

The jumbled sentences above talk about the rewards of successful sales. The author affirms that he spent a lifetime in sales and won numerous laurels. In sentence (2) the author speaks for the first time about being in sales all his life. Sentence (2) is the introductory sentence of the passage because it and it alone begins the passage. The author is at pains to drive home the point that success in sales is determined, not by luck, but by effort. This conviction and experience are underscored in the second sentence (4). There's a cause-and-effect relationship between the first and the second sentences. The cause is the effort (2) and the effect is the jackpot (4). Since both the first and the second sentences are united by a common theme, there is cohesion between them. The author contradicts the belief of his colleagues who attribute his sales success to luck. In the third sentence (1) the author quotes empirical evidence from his data about the cause of success in sales. The third sentence too is cohesively linked to the first and the second sentences through the same thought/sales formula. In the third sentence there is mention of "appointments" and the same word ("appointments") is mentioned again in the fourth sentence (5). There's a cohesive link running through the first four sentences: effort gave rise to sales; sales in turn gave rise to appointments; and appointments in turn gave rise to presentations. The fifth sentence (3) rounds up the formula. The author says presentations produced more sales. So, in short, the author has prescribed the formula for success in sales: effort, not luck.

Ans : (24153)

Directions for question 8: The following question presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

- (1) It is estimated that 330,000 new products are introduced every year in China, most of which are unbranded, and most of which fail.
- (2) One of the reasons behind the Internet's popularity in China has to do with the ways the Web connects shoppers to businesses.
- (3) Since these offer neither great variety nor low prices, customers look to the Internet to get what they need.
- (4) The five largest retailers account for only 10 per cent of the total retail market, so most customers have to buy items at mom-and-pop stores.

Your Answer: 1 ✓

Directions for questions 9 and 10: The following question presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and mark the number corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

- (1) Parents, in general, are not aware of the impact of smartphones on the social, physical and emotional development of their children.
- (2) If the longed-for first smartphone was waiting under the Christmas tree for your pre-teen, the chances are your child had it up and running with favourite apps installed before the turkey was in the oven.
- (3) Familiarise yourself with the parental controls and settings that apply to your child's phone - all devices have some level of restrictions; an internet search should give you details about them; some phone providers and also internet browsers offer parental controls and filters so check those out as well.
- (4) Children get all this access to the world – and the world access to them – when they get an internet-enabled device, so it is very important to monitor their online activity.
- (5) Set up the phone in such a way that they can't install an app without consulting you.

Solution:

The paragraph in general speaks about the smartphone and its ill effects on children. A specific case is taken, of a child whose Christmas gift is a smartphone from his/her mother. Choice 2 humourously starts saying the child would have loaded all the apps in the smartphone even before the festival turkey was in the oven! This is followed by choice 4 which explains how children are exposed to the net and how parents should monitor their child's online activity. Choice 3 follows suggesting some controls which the parents can familiarize themselves with in order to control their child's activity. Choice 5 concludes as to how the child can be educated about the risks and safeguards of using a smartphone. Hence, 2435 forms the proper sequence of the passage. Choice 1 is a general statement and does not form a part of the given of the given sequence.

Ans : (1)

- (1) The Chairperson of SBI indicated recently that restrictions on withdrawals could not be lifted entirely unless more cash is made available to banks.
- (2) Restrictions on cash withdrawal from banks and ATMs are likely to continue beyond the December 30 deadline announced by the government as the currency printing presses and the RBI have not been able to keep pace with the demand for new currency notes.
- (3) The government will not shy away from difficult decisions such as demonetisation, Prime Minister Narendra Modi asserted recently, brushing aside criticism by saying it was an acknowledgement of the rapid pace of growth and development under the NDA's watch.
- (4) As the 50-day deadline for completion of the demonetisation process draws near, bankers seem to agree that the restrictions would have to continue even in the New Year to maintain the orderly working of banks; banks are not in a position to disburse even the current limit of Rs.24,000 a week in many places and are rationing currency depending on availability.
- (5) If this limit is withdrawn for individual and businesses from January 2, banks are unlikely to meet the higher demand for valid currencies given the current cash position ; even bank unions are of the opinion that the restrictions cannot be done away with in one go.

Your Answer: 3 ✓

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Fill in the blanks with the appropriate pair of words.

According to a recent worldwide market study by luxury goods industry adviser Bais and company, the market for luxury goods is estimated to _____ by some 6 - 7% in 2012, _____ the 200 billion mark.

- ☒ a) expand . . . surpassing (Your answer - ✓)
- ☐ b) supercede . . . transecting
- ☐ c) overstep . . . transcending
- ☐ d) swell . . . overcoming

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Fill in the blanks with the appropriate pair of words.

That it took 69 years after independence for India to merge the Railway Budget with the Union Budget is an indication of how difficult it can be to _____ colonial-era traditions that may have _____ their utility.

- ☐ a) shed . . . outgrown
- ☐ b) renounce . . . mitigated

☐ c) junk . . . outlived (Correct Answer - ✓)

☒ d) sever . . . overshadowed (Your answer - ✗)

Solution:

The most suitable pair to fit the blanks is C "junk outlived". 'Junk', when used as a verb, means to get rid of. 'Outlive' is to last longer than.

Choice (C)

Directions for questions 11 to 13: Fill in the blanks with the appropriate pair of words.

Child psychologists believe that _____, the ability to bounce back when bad things happen, is what separates the kids who flourish from those who _____ in stressful situations.

- ☐ a) covetousness . . . waver
- ☐ b) expertness . . . blunder

☒ c) resilience . . . flounder (Your answer - ✓)

☐ d) craftiness . . . panic

Solution:

Working the choices backwards, both 'panic' in (D) and 'flounder' in (C) seem pertinent with respect to 'stressful situations', but 'craftiness' helps rule out the former, as it does not mean the ability to bounce back Hence, option (C) is appropriate.

Choice (C)

Directions for questions 14 and 15: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

ALTERNATE

☐ a) He worked on **alternate** Saturdays in order to complete his work on time.

☐ b) While baking the cake, she used vegetable oil as an **alternate** for canola oil. (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) The geometry teacher asked the students to define an **alternate** angle.

☒ d) The weather was constantly **alternating** between conditions of extreme heat and cold. (Your answer - ✗)

Solution:

The usage of the word alternate is incorrect in statement B. The correct word would be **alternative** in this context. Alternate and alternative have different meanings. Alternative means to be available as another possibility and is thus the correct word usage.
Choices (B)

Directions for questions 14 and 15: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

FACE

☐ a) The President applauded the soldiers for the remarkable courage shown by them in the **face** of danger.

☐ b) Her **face** always lights up whenever she speaks of her school days,

☒ c) Varun's mother set her **face** on his marriage to the girl of his choice. (Your answer - ✓)

☐ d) All the luxury suites in the hotel **face** the sea.